# Group Discussion (GD)

BELH0021

English for Professional Purposes-II

Semester-IV

GLA University, Mathura

# What is Group Discussion?

- A structured exchange of ideas among participants
- Tests communication, leadership, teamwork, and critical thinking
- Common in placements, internships, and academics

Real-life example: Team meeting to solve a project problem

# Turn Taking

- Knowing when to speak and when to listen
- Avoid interrupting others
- WHY?

Ensures equal participation and clarity

- **The 30-Second Rule**:  25-45 seconds per contribution maintains optimal discussion pacing

# **Entry Phrases for Respectful Turn-Taking**:

- "I would like to add to that point…"
- "Building on what [name] mentioned…"
- "That's an interesting perspective. Additionally, I think…"
- "To build on that foundation…"
- "If I may contribute here…"
- "That aligns with my thinking. Furthermore…"

# Building on Ideas

"That's a valid point. What we might add is..."

- "I agree, and this connects to..."
- "Expanding on that concept...“
- *“I would like to connect my point with what was already discussed.”*
- *“Adding to this point, there is another important factor we should consider.”*

# **Handling Disagreement Productively**:

- “I see your perspective. However, consider…"
- "That's one viewpoint. Another angle might be…"
- "I respect that position. The data suggests…“
- *“I partly agree with this view, but I feel there is another side to it.”*
- *“That is a valid point. However, the situation may differ in practical life.”*
- *“I agree with your point, and I would like to add one more aspect.”*
- *“That is an interesting perspective. Another point we can consider is…”*
- *“Let us also look at the advantages and disadvantages of this issue.”*

# Lines to Conclude a Group Discussion

- **Summarizing the Discussion**

*“To conclude, we have discussed different viewpoints, and it is clear that this topic has multiple dimensions.”*

- **Balanced and Professional Ending**

*“In summary, while there are challenges, there are also opportunities if handled properly.”*

- **Problem–Solution Based Conclusion**

*“In conclusion, the problem exists, but with proper planning and awareness, it can be managed effectively.”*

- **Inclusive Closing**

*“Everyone has contributed meaningful points, which helped us understand the topic better.”*

# Exercise: Turn Taking

- Activity:
- Form groups of 6
- Topic: 'Online vs Offline Education'
- Rule: Each speaker gets 30 seconds
- Observe how turn-taking improves discussion quality

# Group Dynamics & Behavior

- Interaction among group members
- Includes leadership, cooperation, conflict handling
- Positive dynamics = productive discussion

Example: Sports team strategy discussion

# Group Etiquette & Mannerism

- Maintain eye contact
- Respect different opinions
- Sit upright and stay attentive
- Avoid aggressive gestures

- WHY?
- Creates professional impression

# Exercise: Identify the Right Behavior

- Instructor shows short situations:
- Interrupting a speaker
- Encouraging a silent member
- Dominating the discussion

- Task: Identify correct vs incorrect behavior

# Tips for Effective GD

- Be clear and concise
- Stick to the topic
- Support ideas with examples
- Stay calm and confident
- Summarize when appropriate

# Mini GD Practice

- Topic:
- 'Artificial Intelligence: Opportunity or Threat?'

- Instructions:
- 10 minutes discussion
- 1 moderator
- 1 student summarizes

# Reflection & Takeaway

- GD is about teamwork, not winning
- Listening is as important as speaking
- Practice improves confidence

- Assignment:
- Write 5 do’s and 5 don’ts of GD